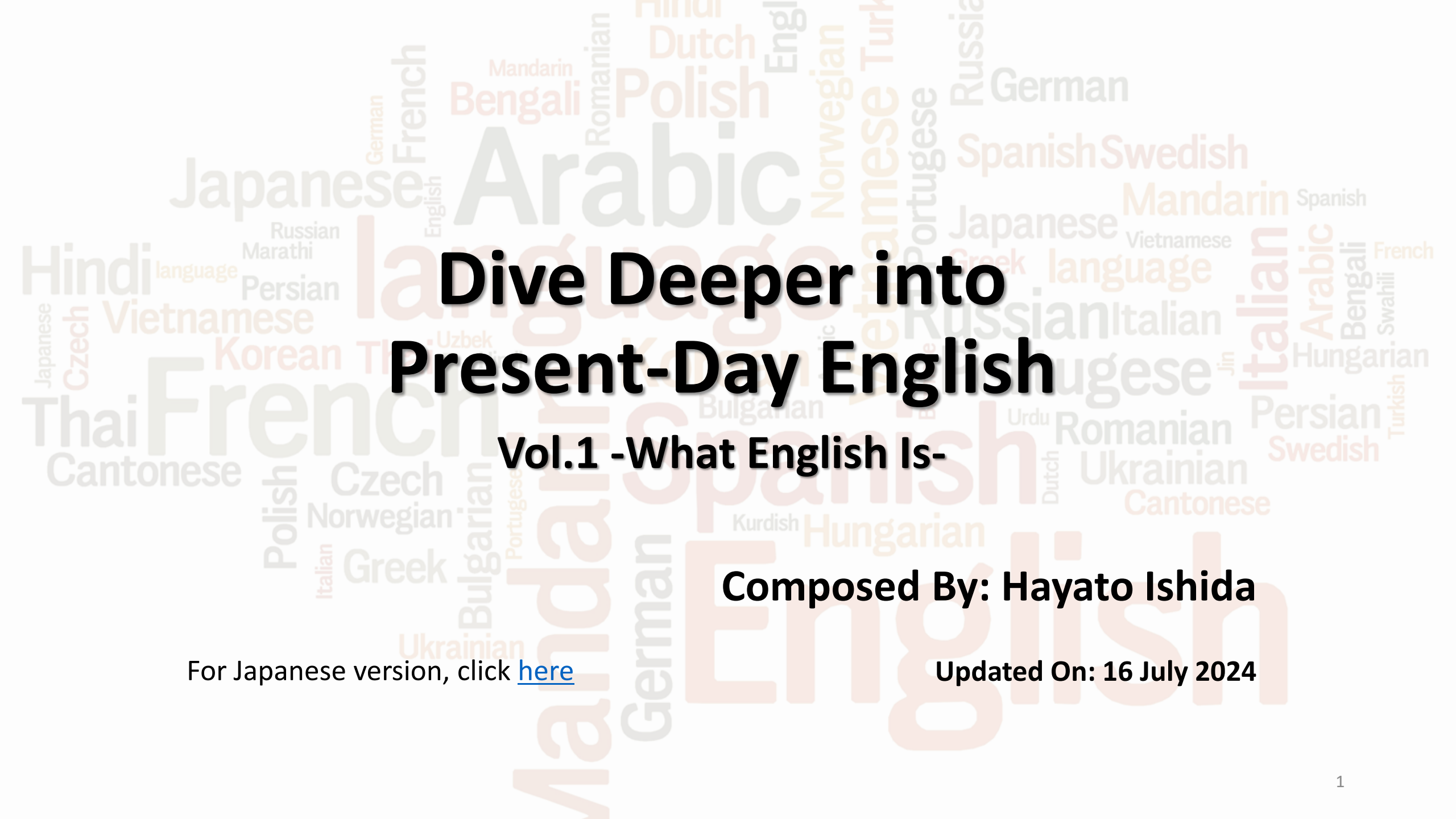




# **Dive Deeper into Present-Day English**

**Vol.1 -What English Is-**

**Composed By: Hayato Ishida**

For Japanese version, click [here](#)

**Updated On: 16 July 2024**

# About Me

- Accounts
  - GitHub: [@hayat01sh1da](#)
  - X: [@hayat01sh1da](#)
  - LinkedIn: [@hayat01sh1da](#)
  - Speaker Deck: [@hayat01sh1da](#)
  - Docswell: [@hayat01sh1da](#)
- Occupation: Software Engineer
- Things I Am Into
  - Linguistics
  - Singing at Karaoke
  - Listening to Music
  - Watching Movies
  - Cat Feeding



# Licences / Certifications

- English
  - TOEIC® Listening & Reading 915: Certified on December 2019
- Engineering
  - Information Security Management: Certified on November 2017
  - Applied Information Technology Engineer: Certified on June 2017
  - Fundamental Information Technology Engineer: Certified on November 2016
  - IT Passport: Certified on April 2016
- Others
  - Abacus 2nd Class: Certified on June 2002
  - Mental Arithmetic 3rd Class: Certified on February 2001

# Skill Stack

- Languages
  - Japanese: Native Proficiency
  - English: Full professional Proficiency
- Development
  - **Backend:** Ruby(Ruby on Rails), Python
  - Frontend: TypeScript + React.js, TypeScript +Vue.js
  - **Database:** MySQL, PostgreSQL, MongoDB
  - **Architecture:** Monolith, Modular Monolith
  - Hosting: AWS ESK
  - Versioning: Git, GitHub
  - **CI/CD:** GitHub Actions, ArgoCD
  - Monitoring: Datadog, Sentry

# Work Histories

| Period              | Genre                     | Position          | Jobs                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|---------------------|---------------------------|-------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Aug 2021 - Present  | SaaS(Educational Service) | Software Engineer | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Backend Development</li><li>• Frontend Development</li><li>• CI/CD Maintenance</li><li>• Weekly Release Manager</li><li>• Troubleshooting</li><li>• Documentation</li><li>• Technical Debt Resolution</li><li>• Tech Blog Entries</li><li>• LT Speaker</li></ul> |
| Feb 2020 - Dec 2020 | SaaS(Chatbot Platform)    | Backend Engineer  | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Backend Development</li><li>• Documentation</li><li>• Technical Debt Resolution</li><li>• Inspection of Alternative API</li></ul>                                                                                                                                |

# Work Histories

| Period              | Genre                      | Position          | Jobs                                                                                                                                                                                            |
|---------------------|----------------------------|-------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Jun 2018 - Jan 2020 | Contract-basis Developer   | Software Engineer | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Backend Development</li><li>• Frontend Development</li><li>• Troubleshooting</li><li>• Quality Assurance</li><li>• Tech Blog Entries</li></ul>          |
| Apr 2016 - Jan 2018 | System Engineering Service | System Engineer   | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Corporate Account Admin</li><li>• Windows Server Maintenance</li><li>• Security Admin Assistant</li><li>• Internationalisation / Localisation</li></ul> |

# International-Exchange Activities

- Activities in University
  - English Linguistics Seminar(Focusing on Mass Media English)
  - International-Exchange Clubs(The 2nd Year)
  - [International-Exchange Programmes conducted by Japan Cabinet Office](#)(2013 - 2016)
  - Japanese Linguistics Course(The Final Year)
- Overseas Life Experience
  - Working Holiday in Australia(April 2014 - March 2015)
    - Language School for 1 month in Sydney
    - Work for 6 Months in [Hamilton Island Resort](#)
    - Volunteering for 1 Month as Assistant Teacher of Japanese Language at [St Ives High School](#) in NSW
- Other Activities
  - Keep Everyday Journal in English (April 2014 - Present)
  - [Sunrise Toastmasters Club](#)(February 2017 - March 2018)
  - [Vital Japan](#)(January 2018 - July 2019, October 2022 - February 2023)
  - Self Learning and Training of English Language
  - Participation Ruby-Related Tech Conferences

# Goals of This Series

- **To know how deep English Language is**
  - Not simply a communication tool
- **To know your own language by knowing another**
  - "He who knows no foreign languages knows nothing of his own." by Johann Wolfgang von Goethe
- **To pursue the essence that does not instantly but work later on**
  - Something which you think is meaningless has something genuine

# Agenda

1. [Periods of English Language](#)
2. [Relation between Language Families and Learning Costs](#)
3. [Specific Features of Present-Day English](#)
4. [Summary](#)
5. [References](#)

A word cloud featuring various languages in different sizes and colors (shades of orange, red, and grey). The languages include Arabic, Spanish, English, French, Japanese, Hindi, Vietnamese, Korean, Thai, Cantonese, Polish, Czech, Norwegian, Greek, Bulgarian, Portuguese, Ukrainian, German, Italian, Russian, Mandarin, Bengali, Persian, Urdu, Romanian, Hungarian, Swedish, Persian, Turkish, and others. The word 'language' is also present in a smaller font. Overlaid on the word cloud is the title '1. Periods of English Language' in a bold, black, sans-serif font.

# 1. Periods of English Language

# 1. Periods of English Language

| Periods                                        | Eras                    | Linguistically and Historically Important Events                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
|------------------------------------------------|-------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Proto-Indo-European</b><br>→ Proto-Germanic | B.C. 1000<br>- A.D. 400 | <b>Grimm's Law(The 1st Consonants Shift)</b> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Organised sound changes were made in some consonants</li> <li>e.g., /p/ → /f/, /t/ → /p/, /k/ → /h/, /kw/ → /hw/</li> </ul>                                                                              |
| <b>Old English</b>                             | 500 - 1100              | <b>Vikings Conquest of English</b> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Creation of Dane Law in the late 9th Century</li> <li>Dominance by the Dane from the early to middle 11th Century</li> <li>Absorption of Old Norse Words into English via Language Conflicts</li> </ul>            |
| <b>Middle English</b>                          | 1100 - 1500             | <b>Norman Conquest</b> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>French as the Official Language in England(Spoken by the Rulers)</li> <li>English as an unofficial Language in England(Spoken by the Ruled)</li> <li>Absorption of French Words into English via Language Conflicts</li> </ul> |
| <b>Modern English</b>                          | 1500 - 1800             | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li><b>Great Vowel Shift:</b> Long Vowels to Double Vowels(e.g., name)</li> <li><b>Increased Loan Words:</b> Via active trades in the Age of Discovery</li> </ul>                                                                                         |
| <b>Present-Day English</b>                     | 1800 - Present          | <b>Development of IT and Mass Media:</b> Emergence of New Vocabulary                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |

# 1. Periods of English Language

47. *The Language Illustrated.* We have spoken of the inflections of Old English in some detail primarily with the object of making more concrete what is meant when we call the language in this stage synthetic. In the later chapters of this book, we shall have occasion to trace the process by which English lost a great part of this inflectional system and became an analytic language, so that the paradigms which we have given here will also prove useful as a point of departure for that discussion. The use of these inflections as well as the other characteristics of the language so far pointed out may be seen in the following specimens. The first is the Lord's Prayer, the clauses of which can easily be followed through the modern form, which is familiar to us from the King James version of the Bible.

Fæder ure,  
þu þe eart on heofonum,  
si þin nama gehālgod.  
Tobecume þin rice.  
Gewurpe ðin willa on eorðan swā swā on heofonum.  
Ūrne gedæghwāmlīcan hlāf syle ūs tō dæg.  
And forgyf ūs ūre gyltas, swā swā wē forgyfað ūrum gyltendum.  
And ne gelæd þu ūs on costnunge,  
ac, ālȳs ūs of yfele. Sōþlice.

The second specimen is from the Old English translation of Bede's *Ecclesiastical History* and tells the story of the coming of the missionaries to England under St. Augustine in 597:

Ða wæs on þā tid Æþelbeorht cuning hāten on Centrice, and  
Thæn (there) was at that time a king named Æthelberht in Kent, and (so)  
mihitig; hē hæfde rice oð gemæru Humber streāmes, sē tōscādeþ  
mighty (one); he had dominion up to (the) confines of the Humber river, which separates  
sūðfolc Angelþeode and norðfolc. Þonne is on eastwearde Cent  
the south folk of the English and the north folk. Now there is in eastward Kent  
micel ēaland, Tenet, þæt is six hund hīda micel after Angelcynnes  
a large island, Thanet, that is six hundred hides large after the reckoning of the  
eahte. . . . On þysum ēalande cōm ūp sē Godes þeow Augustinus  
English. . . . On this island came up the servant of God, Augustine,  
and his gefēran; wæs hē fēwertiga sum. Nāmon hīe ēac swelce him  
and his companions; he was one of forty. Took they likewise with them  
wealhstodas of Franclande mid, swā him Sanctus Gregorius bebēad.  
servant from Frank-land, as then Saint Gregory bade.  
And þā sende to Æþelbeorhte ærendwrecan and onbēad þæt hē  
And then (Augustine) sent to Æthelberht a messenger and announced that he

of Rōme cōme and þæt betste ærende lādde; and sē þe him hiersum  
from Rome had come and the best message brought (one); and he who (if any) would  
bēon wolde, būton twēon hē gehēt ēcne gefean on heofonum and  
be obedient to him, without doubt, he promised eternal happiness in heaven and  
tōweard rice būton ende mid þone sōþan God and þone lifigendan.  
a future kingdom without end with the true God and the living (God).  
Ðā hē þā sē cuning þās word gehierde, þa hēt hē hīe bīdan on þæm  
When the king heard these words, then bade he them to bide on the  
ēalande þe hīe ūp cōmon; and him bīder hīera þearfe forgēaf, oð þæt  
island that they had come up on; and them showed their need provided, until that  
hē gesāwe hwæt hē him dōn wolde. Swelce ēac ær þæm becom hlisa  
he saw what he would do with them. Likewise ere that had come to him  
tō him þære crīstenan æfæstnesse, forþon hē crīsten wif hæfde,  
the fame of the Christian religion, since he had a Christian wife,  
him gegiefen of Francena cuningcynne, Beorhte wæs hāten. Þæt wif  
given him from the royal family of the Franks, (who) was named Bertha. That wife  
hē onfeng fram hīere ieldrum þære āfæstnesse þæt heo his lēafnesse  
he received from her parents (sisters) on the condition that she should have his  
hæfde þæt heo þone þeaw þæs crīstenan gelēafan and hīere æfæstnesse  
permission that she the practice of the Christian faith and her religion  
ungewemmedne healdan mōste mid þy bīscop, þone þe hīe hīere  
unimpaired might hold with the bishop whom they to her  
tō fultume þæs gelēafan sealdon, þæs nama wæs Lēodheard.  
for the help of the (her) faith had given, whose name was Lootheard.

Ðā wæs after manigum dagum þæt sē cuning cōm tō þæm ēalande.  
Then it was after many days that the king came to the island  
and hēt him ūte settl gewyrcean; and hēt Augustinum mid his  
and commanded (them) in the open air a seat to make him, and he bade Augustine with his  
gefērum bīder tō his sprāce cuman. Warnode hē him þy lēs hīe  
companions to come thither to a (his) consultation. He guarded himself lest they  
on hwelc hūs tō him inēoden; brēc caldre hēalsunga, gif hīe hwelcne  
in the same house with him should enter: he employed an old precaution in case they any  
drȳcræft hæfden þæt hīe hine oferswiðan and beswīcan sceolden. . . .  
scurvy had with which they should overcome and get the better of him. . . .  
Þā hēt sē cuning hīe sittan, and hīe swā dydon; and hīe sōna him  
Then the king bade them to sit, and they did so; and they soon to him  
līfes word ætgædere mid callum his gefērum þe þær æt wæron,  
the word of life together with all his companions that thereat were,  
bodedon and lārdon. Þā andswarode sē cuning and þus cwæð:  
preached and taught. Then answered the king and thus quoth:  
"Fæger word þis sindon and gehāt þe gē brōhton and ās secgað.  
"Fair words these are and promises that ye have brought and say to us.  
Ac forðon hīe nīwe sindon and uncūde, ne magon wē nū gēn þæt  
But since they new are and unknown, we may not yet consent to this  
þafian þæt wē forlæten þā wisan þe wē langre tide mid calle  
that we give up the ways that we longtime with all

A word cloud of various languages. The words are arranged in a circular pattern, with some languages appearing more frequently than others. The colors of the words range from light yellow to dark brown. The word 'language' is prominent in the center, and 'English' is at the bottom. Other visible languages include Arabic, Spanish, French, German, Japanese, Hindi, Vietnamese, Russian, Italian, Portuguese, Dutch, Swedish, Persian, Greek, Czech, Polish, Norwegian, Bulgarian, Ukrainian, Romanian, Urdu, Hungarian, Turkish, Bengali, Marathi, Persian, Uzbek, Kurdish, and Cantonese.

## 2. Relation between Language Families and Learning Costs

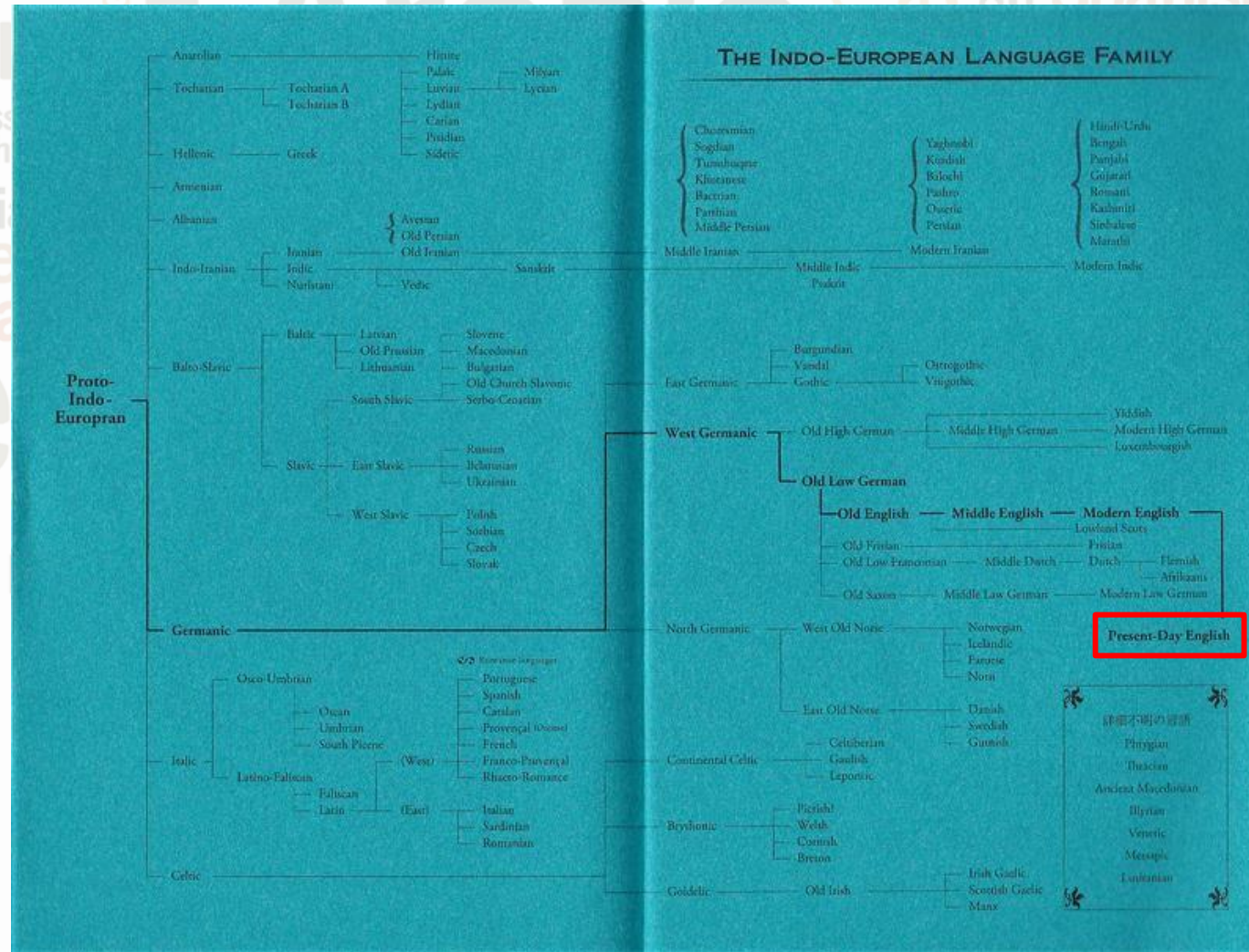
## 2. Relation between Language Families and Learning Costs

### What Language Family Is

All existing languages in the world today can trace back to the specific original language.

The group of languages derived from the original one is called **Language Family**.

## 15



## 2. Relation between Language Families and Learning Costs

### Germanic Languages

- English
- German
- Dutch
- Flemish
- Danish
- Swedish
- Norwegian

## 2. Relation between Language Families and Learning Costs

### Romantic Languages

- Portuguese
- Spanish
- Catalan
- Provençal
- French

## 2. Relation between Language Families and Learning Costs

### Celtic Languages

- Welsh
- Breton
- Irish Gaelic
- Scottish Gaelic

## 2. Relation between Language Families and Learning Costs

### German Language vs. Japanese Language

| Items to Compare                        | German Language                                        | Japanese Language                                 |
|-----------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|
| Least Required Learning Hours           | Approx. 480 hours                                      | Approx. 2500 hours                                |
| Language Family                         | Germanic Language<br>→ Same as English Language        | Unknown<br>✕ Probably Altai Language              |
| Grammatical Feature                     | <b>Inflections</b><br>→ Changes of Form based on Cases | <b>Agglutination</b><br>→ Subjective to Particles |
| Affinity to Present-Day English         | Proto-Indo-European Rooted                             | Natural Gender                                    |
| Difference from the Present-Day English | Grammatical Genders and Inflections                    | Grammatical Conjugations                          |

## 2. Relation between Language Families and Learning Costs

That is to say...

**Languages which belong to a different and far language family from yours are difficult to acquire.**

→ It is very natural for Japanese learners of English languages to take a lot of pains.



### 3. Specific Features of Present-Day English

# 3. Specific Features of Present-Day English

## Top 3 Pros

| Features                                 | Details                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Notes                                                                                                                                                                                          |
|------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Rich Loan Words                          | Load words absorbed from languages all over the world provide rich expressions and solidarity to those who learn English as a foreign language.                                                                                                                                          | Words whose root is either Latin or French account for over 50% of English vocabulary.                                                                                                         |
| Loss of Grammatical Gender               | <b>Natural Gender</b><br>→ <i>man</i> is masculine, <i>girl</i> is feminine and all other words are neuters. The gender of the object agrees with the grammatical gender.                                                                                                                | German has grammatical genders.<br>[Masculine] <i>sunne</i> (sun)<br>[Feminine] <i>mond</i> (moon)<br>[Neuter] <i>weib</i> (wife)                                                              |
| Simplification of Grammatical Inflection | Proto-Indo-European had <b>8</b> cases which were <b>nominative, genitive, dative, accusative, ablative, locative, instrumental</b> and <b>vocative</b> . Present-Day English has only <b>2</b> cases: <b>subjective</b> and <b>genitive</b> .<br>Finish has as many as <b>14</b> cases. | The genitive marker ' <b>s</b> in Present-Day English is derived from the postfixes of genitive in Proto-Indo-European. It co-exists with <b>of + noun</b> today although the latter prevails. |

### 3. Specific Features of Present-Day English

#### Top 2 Cons

| Features                                                   | Details                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Notes                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Huge Difference Between Spellings and Pronunciation</b> | It is too difficult to predict the accurate pronunciation from the spellings.<br>e.g., <i>name</i> , <i>foreign</i> , <i>archive</i> ,<br><i>bouquet</i> , <i>draught</i> , <i>indict</i>                      | <i>ghoti</i> is pronounced as /fɪʃ/, which is a famous joking. <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• <b>gh</b> sounds same as <i>enough</i>(voiceless).</li><li>• <b>o</b> sound same as <i>women</i>(i-mutation).</li><li>• <b>ti</b> sounds the same as <i>station</i>(voiceless).</li></ul>                         |
| <b>Too Many Idioms</b>                                     | Loss of inflection gave rise to development of propositions. They are combined with other classes such as proverbs and produces so many idioms, which are difficult to grammatically explain their structures. | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Inflections in Old English were generous word orders; however, Present-Day English is strict on it after they were historically gone.</li><li>• e.g., "A dog bit a man." and "A man bit a dog." has the completely opposite relations between each subject and object.</li></ul> |

# 3. Specific Features of Present-Day English

## Other Features

| Items                                                            | Values                |
|------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------|
| The Number of Native English Speakers                            | Approx. 400 Millions  |
| The Number of English Speakers as the second or foreign language | Approx. 1.2 billions  |
| The Number of English-Speaking Countries and Regions             | Approx. 30            |
| The Share of English in the Field of Post                        | Approx. 75%           |
| The Share of English in the Field of Technology                  | Approx. 80%           |
| The Number of Words on The Oxford English Dictionary             | Approx. 500,000 Words |
| The Number of Original Languages of Loan Words                   | Approx. 350 Languages |
| The Ration of English Vocabulary Latin and French Account For    | More than 50%         |
| The Duration of The History of English Language                  | Approx. 1500 years    |



## 4. Summary

1. English language has 4 periods.
2. English language and Japanese language have totally different roots each.
3. Present-Day English has representative 3 pros and 2 cons in the linguistic sense.



## 5. References

- Albert C. Baugh and Thomas Cable, *A HISTORY OF ENGLISH LANGUAGE sixth edition*, London and New York, Routledge, 2013
- Kiyoaki Kikuchi ・ Kazutomo Karasawa ・ Ryuichi Hotta ・ Yasuyuki Kaizuka, 英語史：現代英語の特質を求めて-多文化性と国際性-, *Osaka*, 関西人文科学出版会, 2009
- Kiyoaki Kikuchi ・ Kazutomo Karasawa ・ Takeshi Koike ・ Ryuichi Hotta ・ Kazuki Fukuda ・ Yasuyuki Kaizuka ・ Takeshi Matsuzaki, 英語学：現代英語をより深く知るために-現代英語の諸相と英語学術語解説-, *Osaka*, 浪漫書房, 2008
- Kazutomo Karasawa, 英語のルーツ, Kanagawa, 春風社, 2011

# EOD